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SUPERSEDING
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MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BACON, CANADIAN-STYLE, CURED, SMOKED, SLICED, IN BRINE, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers Canadian-style bacon in brine, thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

TT-C-495	-	Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8905

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MILITARY

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit; Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

OTHER GOVERNMENT DOCUMENTS

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Market Research and Development Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Drinking Water WH550, Environmental Protection Agency, Washington, DC 20460.)

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2.2 Other publications. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets, or MS standards), the text of this document shall take precedence. Nothing in this document, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.4, 6.1, and 6.3).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-flavors, off-odors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Pork. Pork loins shall be the only meat ingredient used and shall be derived from recognized fully trimmed pork loins, consisting of the whole-muscle loin-eye, without further reduction in muscle configuration (shall not be a restructured product). The pork loins shall not be a water-added product and shall be in excellent condition, i.e., exposed lean and fat surfaces shall be of a color and bloom normally associated with the class, grade, and cut of meat, and typical of meat which has been properly stored and handled. Cut surfaces and naturally exposed lean surfaces shall show no more than slight darkening or discoloration due to dehydration, aging, or microbial activity. The fat shall show no more than a slight discoloration due to oxidation or microbial activity. No odors foreign to fresh meat shall be present. Changes in color and odor characteristically associated with vacuum-packaged meat in excellent condition shall be acceptable. The pork shall show no evidence of freezing, defrosting, or mishandling. Coarse-textured, dark pork or pale, soft, and exudative (PSE) pork is not acceptable.

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3.2.1.1 Boning and trimming. Pork loins shall be made boneless and trimmed to comply with the limitations listed in tables I and II. Pork shall be trimmed of fat to a degree necessary to assure compliance with finished product fat requirements. The boneless pork loins, so trimmed, shall be in the weight range of 6 to 10 pounds, inclusive. All pork shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) certificate to certify condition of the product and compliance with boning and trimming requirements.

3.2.1.2 Handling and storage. Handling and storage of the boned and trimmed pork loins, prior to further processing, shall be in accordance with the following requirements:

a. Pork processed on the day of initial certification shall be maintained in the temperature range of 28° to 50°F, inclusive.

b. Holding in the fresh-chilled state for not more than 4 days after certification is permitted, provided the pork is maintained in the temperature range of 28° to 40°F, inclusive.

c. Holding in the frozen state for not more than 120 days after placement in the freezer is permitted, provided that the pork is:

- placed in the freezer within 4 hours after certification
- frozen to 0°F or lower within 72 hours after placement in the freezer
- stored at 0°F or lower
- protected from freezer deterioration and damage
- stored in containers that are adequate to maintain product excellence
- held after storage at an internal temperature not to exceed 40°F when further processing is resumed.

3.2.2 Salt. Salt shall be noniodized, white, refined sodium chloride with or without anticaking agents.

3.2.3 Water. Water used for formulation, ice making, and washing shall conform to the National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Preparation of Canadian-style bacon. The boned and trimmed pork loins shall be commercially cured, stuffed into fibrous-type casings, cooked, and smoked in accordance with the USDA Meat and Poultry Inspection. The curing solution shall contain no dextrose. The diameter of the cooked and smoked pork loins shall be approximately 3-1/4 inches after removal from the smokehouse.

3.3.1.1 Cooling and freezing. The cured, cooked, and smoked pork loins (log) shall be cooled to 40°F or below immediately following removal from the

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smokehouse. The cooled, cooked pork loin logs shall be held not longer than 48 hours at a temperature not to exceed 40°F after removal from the cooking process and prior to slicing. Alternatively, if the cooked meat logs are to be held longer than 48 hours after cooking, they shall be placed in a freezer within 4 hours after removal from the smokehouse and frozen to 0°F or lower within 24 hours after being placed in the freezer. In this case, the meat shall not have been previously frozen prior to cooking. The frozen, cooked pork loin logs shall be held at 0°F for a period not more than 14 days prior to slicing. The frozen meat logs shall be tempered to a range of 28° to 40°F prior to slicing.

3.3.1.2 Slicing of Canadian-style bacon. The pork loin logs with casing removed shall be sliced into slices having uniform size and shape to yield 14 slices per pound. The time from slicing to filling shall be not more than 4 hours.

3.3.2 Brine preparation.

a. Salt shall be completely dissolved in water to provide a 2.0 to 2.5 percent brine (salt) solution. (Salt tablets may be substituted for granular salt in brine preparation).

b. Brine shall be made fresh daily, and brine remaining at the end of a production day shall be discarded.

3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with product such as to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. No less than 60 intact slices of Canadian-style bacon shall be shingled in two rows, lengthwise, in the tray pack can.

b. The tray pack can shall be filled with brine. Brine may be filled hot or cold.

c. The temperature of the Canadian-style bacon slices at time of filling shall be 28° to 40°F.

d. Immediately after filling, each can shall be hermetically sealed under a vacuum of 5 to 8 inches of mercury as determined by presence of visible concavity of the can lid.

e. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in the retort process within 1 hour after sealing.

3.5 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be thermostabilized by retorting until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6 has been achieved.

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3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, glass, paint, metal, dirt, insects, insect parts, hair, wood, or paper.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to, rancid, scorched, burnt, stale, sour, musty, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. There shall be no void areas that measure more than 0.5 inch in any dimension.

e. No individual can shall contain less than 102 ounces.

f. The average total can content weight shall be not less than 104 ounces.

g. No individual can shall contain less than 48.0 ounces drained weight of Canadian-style bacon slices.

h. The texture of the slices shall not be dry, rubbery, or mushy.

i. At least 60 slices shall be intact with a uniform and circular surface appearance.

j. The average fat content of the finished product shall be not greater than 8.0 percent and no individual tray pack shall have a fat content greater than 10.0 percent.

k. The salt content of the finished product shall be not less than 0.5 percent nor greater than 2.5 percent.

l. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

3.6.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The pork loin component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this document. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of supervision necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this document.

4.3 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this document and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this document or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Pork loin examination for condition and cut. All pork loins shall be examined in the bone-in state for conformance to the condition and cut requirements in 3.2.1. Any nonconforming pork shall be rejected.

4.5.1.2 Boned and trimmed pork loin examination. After boning and trimming and prior to any further processing, the pork loins shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. The lot size expressed in terms of pounds shall be declared to the Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) agent by the contractor. However, the AMS agent reserves the right to declare as a lot a portion of a declared lot, if, in his or her opinion, that portion may be out of compliance with any requirement. The sample unit shall be a minimum of 12 pounds of adjacent boneless pork loins. The sample size shall be as specified in table I. If all or a portion of the sample unit falls within a larger cut, the entire cut shall be examined. Failure of the pork loins to meet the acceptable criteria as indicated in table I shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Except for pork loins rejected because of not being in excellent condition, the pork loins may be reworked by the contractor and reoffered for examination. For reexamination, the sampling plan used shall be the one in table I designed for

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the next larger lot size than the one under which the lot was initially rejected. Pork loins shall not be reexamined more than one time.

TABLE I. Sampling plan for boned and trimmed pork loins

Lot size (pounds)	Sample size (No. of) sample units)	Defects categories			
		Major		Minor	
		AC	RE	AC	RE
500 or less	13	1	2	3	4
501 to 1200	20	2	3	5	6
1201 to 3200	32	3	4	7	8
3201 to 10,000	50	5	6	10	11
10,001 to 35,000	80	7	8	14	15
Reinspection lots of 10,001 to 35,000	125	10	11	21	22

TABLE II. Boned and trimmed pork loin defects 1/ 2/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Presence of popliteal, prescapular, prefemoral or any exposed lymph gland measuring 0.5 inch or more in any dimension.
102		Presence of blood clot measuring 0.5 inch or more in any dimensions.
	201	Presence of blood clot measuring 0.3 inch or more but less than 0.5 inch.
103		Presence of bruise measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension.
	202	Presence of bruise measuring 0.3 inch or more but less than 1.0 inch in any dimension.
104		Presence of bone measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension.
105		Presence of cartilage measuring 0.5 inch or more in any dimension.

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TABLE II. Boned and trimmed pork loin defects 1/ 2/ (cont'd)

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
	203	Presence of cartilage measuring 0.3 inch or more but less than 0.5 inch in any dimension.
106		Exposed (protruding) ligaments and tendons measuring more than 0.3 inch.
	204	Presence of exposed blood vessel measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension.
	205	Presence of lumber fat.
	206	Presence of dehydrated surface measuring 1.0 square inch or more.
	207	Presence of intercostal meat.
107		Presence of hanging tendor.
108		Presence of tenderloin.

1/ Determination of wholesomeness and acceptability of product with respect to the presence of foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insects, insect parts, hair, wood, metal) or extraneous material (e.g., casing, string) shall be made by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations employee.

2/ Evidence of freezing, or defrosting, or product not in excellent condition shall cause rejection of the lot.

4.5.1.3 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, or compliance be evident by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. In addition, prior to use, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically, as necessary, to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating,

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filling, sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation ... of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The USDA reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.5.3.1 Total can weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 of the empty tray pack cans and lids used in preparing the product and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 1 ounce. If the average total can content weight is less than 104 ounces or if the weight of any individual can is less than 102 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

4.5.3.2 Product inspection. The sample size shall be as indicated by the double sampling plan specified in table III. The tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot. The tray pack cans shall be heated for at least 15 minutes in 140° to 150°F water, opened, and inspected for the defects listed in table IV.

TABLE III. Double sampling plan for product inspection 1/

Lot size (cans)	Sample size (No. of cans)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 3200	8	--	0	2
	8	16	1	2
3201 to 35000	13	--	0	3
	13	26	3	4

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second samples shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

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TABLE IV. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Presence of void areas that measure more 0.5 inch in any dimension.
102	Less than 60 intact, uniform and circular slices in a can.
103	Drained weight of Canadian-style bacon slices is less than 48.0 ounces. 3/
104	Slice texture is dry, rubbery, or mushy.
105	Slice does not consist only of solid muscle loin-eye.
106	Product shows evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched slices).

1/ The presence of foreign material (e.g. glass, dirt, insect parts, insects, paper, hair, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (e.g. burnt, scorched, musty, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (To be determined by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations employee.)

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary an AMS agent.)

3/ To determine drained weight, the free liquid in the can shall be poured off and the remaining contents shall be poured into a flat-bottom container. A minimum of three times the tray pack can's volume of 190° to 212°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be agitated so as to liquify rendered fat without breaking the bacon slices. The contents shall then be poured into a U.S. Standard 1/2 inch sieve in a manner that will distribute the product over the sieve without breaking the bacon slices. Sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted at approximately a 45 degree angle and allowed to drain for 2 minutes before determining the drained weight by subtracting the sieve tare weight from the gross weight. The drained weight shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

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4.5.3.3 Fat and salt content testing. Nine tray pack cans shall be selected at random from the lot and distributed as follows:

- Three for laboratory analysis.
- Three for submission to the contractor.
- Three for retention by an AMS agent as a reserve sample.

The three tray packs for laboratory analyses shall individually be tested for fat and salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, chapter: Meat and Meat Products, except that preparation of the samples shall be as follows: The three unopened cans shall be gently warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the cans. The cans shall be opened and the entire contents of each can shall be separately blended in a Waring blender or equivalent. The lot shall be rejected if:

a. The average fat content of the three tray packs is greater than 8.0 percent.

b. The fat content of any individual tray pack is greater than 10.0 percent.

c. The salt content of any individual tray pack is less than 0.5 percent or greater than 2.5 percent.

Analysis of reserve samples at the request of the contractor shall not be permitted unless the original laboratory analysis indicated that the involved lot will be rejected because of noncompliance with the fat or salt content requirement. When the reserve samples are analyzed, the analyses for both fat and salt shall be made and will be considered final. Unused reserve samples shall be returned to the contractor for inclusion in subsequent lots.

4.5.4 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4).

4.5.5 Can closure examination. Can closures shall be examined visually and by teardowns in accordance with CFR 21, Part 113, Subpart D and the can manufacturer's requirement.

4.5.6 Vacuum examination. Cans shall be examined 24 hours after sealing to determine vacuum retention. To examine, lay a straight edge from bead to bead and verify that the distance from the straight edge to the lid is greater at the middle of the can than near the bead.

4.5.7 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in

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accordance with PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or tape.
Dimensions of pads not as specified.

Minor: Other required markings missing, incorrect or illegible.
Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified.
Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

4.5.8 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. The product shall be preserved in accordance with level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. A size 1001 by 1206 by 200 tray pack can shall be filled, sealed, and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4 and 3.5. The base plate of the can shall be electrolytic chromium-coated steel and shall be of sufficient temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The base plate weight of the body and end of each can shall be 90 pounds per base box. The entire inside area of the can shall be coated. Scratches or fractures shall not penetrate through the interior can coating. The interior can coating shall not peel or blister when in contact with the product. The interior can coating shall neither affect nor be affected by the packaged product. A certificate of conformance shall be furnished to certify compliance with the interior can coating requirements. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495.

5.1.1.1 When specified (see 6.1) the base plate of the can shall be electrolyte chromium-coated steel and shall be of sufficient temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The base plate weight of the body and end of each can shall be 98 pounds per base box. The body design shall be reinforced on the bottom with six longitudinal beads or ribs 0.050 inches $\pm$ 0.010 deep. The beads shall be 9 inches by 3/4 inch in length and width and shall be equidistant in the center panel of the bottom. The end design shall be reinforced with fight longitudinal beads 0.018 inch $\pm$ 0.004 deep. The beads shall be 11 inches by 3/4 inch in length and width and shall be equidistant in the center panel of the end. The center four beads on the end design shall be interrupted to provide a 5 inch by 5 inch flat center panel for labeling. The apex of all the beads shall be outward on the edge. The interior and exterior can coating requirements shall be so specified in 5.1.1.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be preserved as specified in 5.1.1, except that cans with commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

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5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style HSC-L with a HSC full depth cover, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside box dimensions shall be 12-3/4 inches in length by 10-1/2 inches in width by 8-1/2 inches in depth. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box with two cans placed with covers down and two cans with covers up. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads fabricated of grade V3s fiberboard. The dimensions of the fiberboard pads shall be 11-1/4 inches by 9-1/4 inches (± 1/8 inch). The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. Each box shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1) except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load with all courses having the same pattern so as to create columnar stacking. Strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1 except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, - 1/8 inch). The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pad dimensions shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width dimensions of the box and shall be fabricated of the same material as the box.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified except that the unit load shall consist of 48 boxes with 12 boxes per course and four courses per load with all courses having the same pattern so as to create columnar stacking. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray pack can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. In addition, the name of product shall be marked, stamping is permitted, on one 1001 by 200 side of the can. The labeling shall be legible when examined in accordance with 4.5.4 after submerging the can in boiling water for 30 minutes. Paper labels are not permitted. The tray pack cans shall

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include the following information (in capital letters larger than other markings):

Bacon, Canadian-style, Cured, Smoked, Sliced, in Brine, Thermostabilized, Tray Pack

In addition, cans shall show the following statements:

TO HEAT

a. To heat in water: Submerge sealed can in boiling water. Bring to a boil, continue boiling for 40 to 45 minutes. Avoid overheating to the point where internal pressure is evident (can shows evidence of bulging). Remove from water and open lid for serving.
CAUTION: Use care when opening as pressure may have been generated within the can.

b. To heat in oven: Either punch several holes in lid of tray can or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place to prevent moisture loss. Place in a 350°F oven for approximately 35 to 40 minutes until contents reach an internal temperature of 165°F.

WARNING: Do not place closed can in oven, as heating will increase internal pressure which may cause the can to burst.

YIELD

Approximately 20 servings of 3 slices each.

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078. In addition, when tray pack cans are fabricated from 90 pounds per base box, the following precautionary markings in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

CAUTION: DO NOT STACK PALLETS IN TRANSIT OR MORE THAN TWO HIGH IN STORAGE.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this document.

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b. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.3).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.3).
d. Level of preservation and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
e. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).
f. When tray pack cans are to be fabricated from 98 pounds per base box (see 5.1.1.1).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8905-AB30

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INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-B-44232	BACON, CANADIAN-STYLE, CURED, SMOKED, SLICED, IN BRINE, ~~THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK~~

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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